

## THE MOVE

**You have [real basis]. What [small, concrete question] should I check first? -> You know this better than I do - what should I notice first? -> You have worked with these customers. What usually matters most? -> I have a tentative view, but you ?**

## START HERE

Name one real domain where they have more context than you, then ask one small, answerable question: "You know this better than I do - what should I notice first?"

## SAY THIS

|                       |                                                                                              |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Social                | <i>"You know this world better than I do - what should I notice first?"</i>                  |
| Professional          | <i>"You have been closer to this than I have. What would you look at first?"</i>             |
| Narrow asks           | <i>"I will own the decision, but I need your read first. What is the strongest caution?"</i> |
| High-pressure         | <i>"You are closest to the facts. What is the safest first read?"</i>                        |
| Quick forms & digital | <i>"What am I missing?"</i>                                                                  |
| Credit the insight    | <i>"That helps - I had not separated those two issues."</i>                                  |

## AVOID

- Their expertise is not actually relevant here
- They are rushed, overloaded, or already on the hook for too much
- The question asks for too much unpaid labour

## REMEMBER

**Make the expert role smaller than the person.**